

RNA-seq 全流程教程 · 矫正增强版

Contents

RNA-seq 全流程教程 · 矫正增强版 (Corrected & Annotated Edition) 1

0. 关于本版 (About this edition) 1

1. 问题清单速览 (Issues at a glance) 2

2. 环境与数据 (Environment and data) 4

3. 数据获取与原始质控 (rsync + fastqc) 5

4. 接头与质量修剪 (fastp) 5

5. 剪接比对 (STAR) 6

6. 汇总质控 (multiqc) 8

7. 定量 I: 比对模式 (salmon align mode) 8

8. 定量 II: 选择性比对模式 (salmon quasi / --validateMappings) 9

9. 读入定量结果并过滤 (tximport → edgeR) 10

10. 差异表达、注释与火山图 (glmLRT + volcano) 10

11. 富集分析 (GO — and the KEGG that never runs) 11

12. 热图——沉默的全 NA 坑 (the silent all-NA bug) 12

13. 双轮对比 (mini vs homework/full, side by side) 13

14. 检查清单、产物清单与总结 (Checklist, outputs, summary) 14

附录 A. 偏差日志 (both rounds, condensed but verbatim-faithful) 15

附录 B. 教师参考产物 vs 印刷版文档 (evidence, all paths verbatim) 15

附录 C. 复现 (reproduction) 16

RNA-seq 全流程教程 · 矫正增强版 (Corrected & Annotated Edition)

: Document version 1.0 • 2026-10-09 • reproduced from RNA_seq_tutorial_mini.html and RNA_seq_homework.html (course originals), with a two-round full-pipeline reproduction (mini 2026-09-21, homework/full 2026-10-09) and every deviation verified, recorded, and corrected.

0. 关于本版 (About this edition)

This edition is the RNA-seq counterpart of the WES corrected roadmap (WES/ref/WES_roadmap_corrected.md). It mirrors the course originals command-for-command, then adds what the originals do not carry: per-step rationale, real measured numbers from two complete runs, a pitfall registry with root causes, and corrections that were actually executed and verified.

Sources (course originals, kept untouched):

File	Role
RNA_seq_tutorial_mini.html	9-step mini pipeline (10k reads/sample), the in-class executable path
RNA_seq_homework.html	Same pipeline at full read depth on the full GRCh38 index
rna_seq.pdf	14-page theory slides (RNA-seq principles, STAR/Salmon positioning, R basics)
RNA_seq_code_explanation.pdf	9-page line-by-line command commentary

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The two-round reproduction (both rounds: commands verbatim, minimal wrapping, every deviation logged):

Round	Date	Data	STAR index	Where it ran	Runtime
mini	2026-09-21	12 fastq × 10,000 reads (20 MB)	chr22 mini (381 MB)	login node, serial	~4 min
homework (full)	2026-10-09	12 fastq, 118k–227k read pairs (112 MB)	full GRCh38 (~31 GB RAM)	login node, serial	13 min

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Where the rounds ran, and why. The tutorial’s native mode is interactive execution on the login node — the two HTML documents contain no `sbatch/srun/SLURM` references at all; the only cluster-touching command is the initial `ssh`. The teacher’s own load test (`02_simulate_30_students_pipeline.sh`, artifacts under `/lustre1/share/RNA_seq_class/loadtest/mini30_20260928_*`) simulated 30 students running this pipeline **concurrently on the login node**, which is direct evidence that the course design expects login-node execution. The mini round ran during a campus-wide SLURM submission outage (every `sbatch` rejected with `Invalid account or account/partition combination; sacct empty since 9/15`; the WES scripts that had run successfully on 9/20 were also rejected — cluster-side reconfiguration, recorded in the round’s deviations log). The homework round ran on the login node by explicit directive, although SLURM had recovered by probe time (test-only allocation succeeded on `cn-long`). Both choices are recorded in each round’s `log/deviations.log`.

What “corrected” means here (same discipline as the WES edition): run the printed commands as written, log every pitfall encountered or predicted, then fix and verify the fixes with real outputs — the fix evidence is in this repository, not just described. Numbers in this document are measured values from the two runs, not estimates.

How to read each step: every pipeline step carries the same block set — Original (the printed command, verbatim), Rationale (what the tool and its key parameters actually do), What we ran (measured numbers from both rounds), Pitfalls (verified, with evidence), Interpretation, Tuning, and Extensions (where to go next when this step is routine).

1. 问题清单速览 (Issues at a glance)

Verified pitfalls in the course originals. Full evidence and corrections are in the step sections; the two most consequential (RNA-08/10) have dedicated sections.

ID	Where	Symptom / root cause	Correction
RNA-01	R sample_info	Sample identity is positional end-to-end : condition assumes <code>list.files()</code> returns <code>HBR×3</code> then <code>UHR×3</code> (alphabetical luck), and unnamed files give <code>colnames = NULL</code> , so <code>edgeR</code> names samples <code>Sample1–6</code>	Name samples explicitly; assert order before building the design matrix
RNA-02	mini salmon single-sample	Demo cell omits <code>--gcBias</code> but the batch script includes them → systematic correction difference between demo and batch outputs	Use the batch parameters everywhere
RNA-03	homework salmon single-sample	Align-mode demo cell has a mangled filename	Batch script is correct; use it

ID	Where	Symptom / root cause	Correction
		(UHR sample name + a pasted HBR_ERCC-Mix2... chr22 suffix) → file not found	
RNA-04	homework batch_salmon_quasi	for r1 in *read1.fastq.gz matches only raw reads — quasi mode quantifies untrimmed data (mini direct mode used trimmed)	Run as written, record; or point the glob at *.read1.trimmed.fastq.gz
RNA-05	homework batch_STAR.sh	Shebang printed as !/bin/bash (missing #)	Cosmetic; run via bash script.sh
RNA-06	homework multiqc cell	Placeholder path /lustre1/share/RNA_seq_student/yourfold	Point at the real working directory
RNA-07	consolidated “CODES” cell (both docs)	KEGG block wrapped in ''' — not an R comment ; parses as one giant string literal (silently no-ops) and any apostrophe inside would close the string early, turning the rest into live code	The step-by-step cells correctly use #; treat the consolidated cell as non-executable
RNA-08	homework consolidated “CODES” cell	Still filters “_direct” (mini naming) --- homework outputs are _quasi → zero files found, downstream failure	Use the step-by-step path (grep1(“quasi”))
RNA-09	homework heatmap block	gene_map keyed by versioned transcript_id, looked up with version-stripped rownames → every label misses → all 50 rows render as “NA”, silently	Strip versions from the map keys as well (one line); verified 0/50 NA
RNA-10	teacher reference outputs	Teacher’s heatmap_DEG.pdf row labels are versioned ENST IDs — neither gene names nor the all-NA the printed code produces: the reference run used a third code variant	Compare against reference with care; see Appendix B
RNA-11	teacher class.R	salmon_files <- salmon_files[-2] drops the 2nd sample — cleanup of teacher’s own duplicate directory, not a method	Do not replicate; be aware when diffing against reference
RNA-12	interpretation pitfall	Quasi/direct mode maps only 30–37% of reads (selective alignment is conservative); align mode reports 100% (input BAM is pre-	Compare rates only within a mode

ID	Where	Symptom / root cause	Correction
RNA-13	both docs	aligned) — the two are not comparable denominators --runThreadN 1 in single-sample demos vs 4 in the batch script — 1 is a 30-student classroom load decision, not a technical limit	Solo runs may raise threads (mind the shared login node)
RNA-14	R startup	address (nil) ... Segmentation fault in R on this cluster unless LC_ALL=C/LANG=C are exported first	Export both before R/Rscript (tutorial notes this; keep it)
RNA-15	volcano plot	ggrepel: N unlabeled data points (too many overlaps) — informational (9 in mini, 280 in full), labels are just decluttered	Benign; raise max.overlaps if more labels are wanted

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2. 环境与数据 (Environment and data)

Original (setup cells, both docs):

```
ssh .....
mkdir /lustre1/share/RNA_seq_student_2026_homework/{studentId}_{name}
cd /lustre1/share/RNA_seq_student_2026_homework/{studentId}_{name}
conda activate RNA-seq
```

Rationale. The shared environment (/lustre1/share/miniconda3/envs/RNA-seq) carries every tool the pipeline needs, pinned by the course: fastp 0.23.4, FastQC 0.12.1, STAR 2.7.11b, salmon 1.10.3, multiqc, samtools, gffread, and R 4.4.0 with edgeR/limma/tximport/ggplot2/ggrepel/pheatmap/clusterProfiler/org.Hs.eg.db/biomaRt. Activating it (instead of installing per-student) is what makes a 30-student classroom feasible and what the teacher’s load test validates.

The dataset is SEQC — the only RNA-seq set with a truth label. Six paired-end libraries: **HBR ×3** (Human Brain Reference) and **UHR ×3** (Universal Human Reference RNA), each spiked with ERCC controls at two mixes (HBR = Mix2, UHR = Mix1). “Differential expression” here has a known answer: brain-enriched genes are high in HBR, and UHR — a pooled-tissue mix that includes immune-cell RNA — carries high immunoglobulin transcripts. Every downstream sanity check in this edition leans on that truth (section 10). The chr22/ErccTranscripts in filenames marks that the shipped FASTQs were pre-filtered to chr22 (+ ERCC) content.

Teacher-built assets (do not rebuild — the originals mark index-building cells do NOT RUN):

Asset	Path	Size	Used by
chr22 mini STAR index	/lustre1/share/RNA_seq_class/genome/mini_ref_chr22/star_index	381 MB	mini round STAR
chr22 mini salmon index	.../mini_ref_chr22/salmon_index	small	mini round direct mode
chr22 transcriptome fasta	.../mini_ref_chr22/chr22.transcripts.fa	small	mini round align mode

Asset	Path	Size	Used by
full GRCh38 STAR index	/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome	SA 24.9 GB + Genome 3.2 GB + SAindex 1.6 GB ($\approx$ 31 GB RAM to load)	homework round STAR
full transcriptome fasta	/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome/GRCh38_no_alt_analysis_set_gencode.v36.transcripts.fa	368 MB	homework align mode
full salmon index (k31)	/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome/salmon_index	801 MB	homework quasi mode
gene annotation RDS	/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/class/genome/gene_anno_gencode.v36.rds	—	R annotation (transcript_id $\rightarrow$ gene_name)

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Data scale (measured, both rounds):

Round	Files	Reads per sample (pairs)	fastp kept
mini	12 $\times$ 10,000 reads	10,000 reads (5,000 pairs)	— (trimmed lightly)
homework	12 fastq.gz (112 MB)	HBR 118,571–144,826; UHR 162,373–227,392	97.4–98.7%

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3. 数据获取与原始质控 (rsync + fastqc)

Original (homework; mini is identical in shape):

```
rsync --progress /lustre1/share/RNA_seq/RNA_seq_files/*.fastq.gz .
find . -name "*.fastq.gz" -exec fastqc {} -d . -o . \;
totalreads=$(unzip -c HBR_Rep1_ERCC-Mix2_Build37-ErccTranscripts-chr22.read2_fastqc.zip */
fastqc_data.txt | grep 'Total Sequences' | cut -f 2)
echo "Total Sequences: $totalreads"
```

Rationale. rsync (not cp) gives progress and resumability over Lustre. FastQC per file yields the standard module battery (per-base quality, adapter traces, duplication, GC); the homework note DO NOT UNZIP matters twice over — the reads must stay gzipped for `--readFilesCommand zcat` later, and `unzip -c reads_fastqc_data.txt` **out of the zip without extracting anything**.

What we ran. Both rounds: 12 fastqc zips. Total Sequences per file confirmed the scales above (mini: 10,000 per file; homework: read1 = read2 counts, 118,571...227,392 per file).

Pitfalls. None at this step beyond the obvious (running fastqc from the wrong directory silently finds nothing; the `find -exec` runs serially — fine at this size).

Tuning. FastQC accepts `-t` threads; at 12 files it is unnecessary. **Extensions.** multiqc (section 6) aggregates these reports; fastq_screen would add contamination profiling.

4. 接头与质量修剪 (fastp)

Original (batch cell; single-sample demo cell is the same command one-off):

```
for file in *.read1.fastq.gz
do
    base=$(basename "$file" .read1.fastq.gz)
    read1_file="${base}.read1.fastq.gz"
    read2_file="${base}.read2.fastq.gz"
    output_read1="${base}.read1.trimmed.fastq.gz"
    output_read2="${base}.read2.trimmed.fastq.gz"
```

```

    json_report="${base}.fastp.json"
    html_report="${base}.fastp.html"
    fastp -i "$read1_file" -I "$read2_file" -o "$output_read1" -O "$output_read2" --
detect_adapter_for_pe -l 25 -j "$json_report" -h "$html_report"
done

```

Rationale. --detect_adapter_for_pe infers the adapter pair from PE read overlap — no adapter sequence needs to be known ahead. -l 25 discards reads shorter than 25 bp after trimming (STAR degrades on very short inputs). The per-sample JSON/HTML pair is what multiqc will consume.

What we ran (homework round, all six samples):

Sample	Reads in	Reads out	Kept
HBR_Rep1	237,142	234,120	98.7%
HBR_Rep2	289,652	285,044	98.4%
HBR_Rep3	259,572	256,166	98.7%
UHR_Rep1	454,784	444,834	97.8%
UHR_Rep2	324,746	317,040	97.6%
UHR_Rep3	370,884	361,336	97.4%

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Interpretation. ~97–99% survival means the libraries are clean: adapter content low, quality high — consistent with a commercial reference RNA lot. UHR trims slightly more than HBR (pool composition, slightly more short fragments).

Pitfalls. None new; note that the trimmed filenames (*.read1.trimmed.fastq.gz) are what STAR's loop matches, while the homework quasi-mode loop matches the **raw** names (RNA-04) — the two globs encode two different preprocessing intents.

Tuning. --qualified_quality_phasing/--cut_front etc. exist but SEQC libraries need none of them. **Extensions.** cutadapt/trim-galore are equivalent alternatives; --overlap_len tightening helps when PE overlap detection over-trims.

5. 剪接比对 (STAR)

Original (homework batch script; single-sample demo identical except --runThreadN 1):

```

GENOMEDIR="/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome"
for file in *.read1.trimmed.fastq.gz
do
    base=$(basename "$file" .read1.trimmed.fastq.gz)
    read1_file="${base}.read1.trimmed.fastq.gz"
    read2_file="${base}.read2.trimmed.fastq.gz"
    output_prefix="${base}"
    STAR --runThreadN 4 \
        --genomeDir $GENOMEDIR \
        --readFilesIn "$read1_file" "$read2_file" \
        --outFileNamePrefix "$output_prefix" \
        --readFilesCommand zcat \
        --outSAMtype BAM Unsorted \
        --outFilterType BySJout \
        --alignSJoverhangMin 8 \
        --outFilterMultimapNmax 20 \
        --alignSJDBoverhangMin 1 --outFilterMismatchNmax 999 \
        --outFilterMismatchNoverReadLmax 0.04 \
        --alignIntronMin 20 \
        --alignIntronMax 1000000 \
        --alignMatesGapMax 1000000 \

```

```
--quantMode TranscriptomeSAM \
--outSAMattributes NH HI AS NM MD
```

done

Rationale (parameters that matter). STAR is splice-aware: it seeds with exact k-mers (default 50 for 100 bp reads), extends, and scores spliced alignments against a splice-junction database built into the index. `--outFilterType BySJout` keeps an intron-containing alignment only if its junction is supported by at least one other read (or the annotated SJ database) — the main junk-intron filter. `--alignSJoverhangMin 8` requires ≥ 8 bases on each side of a novel junction. `--outFilterMultimapNmax 20` allows up to 20 loci (immunoglobulin and repetitive regions genuinely multi-map). `--outFilterMismatchNmax 999 + --outFilterMismatchNoverReadLmax 0.04` together cap mismatches at 4% of read length. Intron bounds 20... 1,000,000 and mates-gap 1 Mb are the GENCODE-compatible envelope. `--quantMode TranscriptomeSAM` is **the step’ s load-bearing choice**: it additionally emits `<prefix>Aligned.toTranscriptome.out.bam`, coordinates converted to transcript space — the exact input salmon’ s align mode consumes (section 7). `--outSAMattributes NH HI AS NM MD` emits multimapping hierarchy and mismatch tags that downstream tools expect.

What we ran (unique / multi / unmapped-too-short, per sample):

Round	Sample	Unique %	Multi-loci %	Too short %
mini	HBR_Rep1	53.25	0.68	12.48
mini	HBR_Rep2	53.03	0.68	11.98
mini	HBR_Rep3	53.33	0.48	12.90
mini	UHR_Rep1	46.76	2.02	11.86
mini	UHR_Rep2	49.94	2.08	11.49
mini	UHR_Rep3	45.06	1.90	12.87
homework	HBR_Rep1	51.82	1.09	47.08
homework	HBR_Rep2	51.70	1.11	47.19
homework	HBR_Rep3	51.77	1.06	47.17
homework	UHR_Rep1	45.30	2.77	51.92
homework	UHR_Rep2	48.47	3.02	48.50
homework	UHR_Rep3	44.56	2.77	52.66

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Interpretation. Three signals, all stable across rounds and depths: (1) **HBR maps ~5 points better than UHR** — the brain reference is a single-tissue RNA with fewer immunoglobulin/repetitive transcripts; UHR’ s pool includes IG genes that genuinely multi-map (UHR multi-loci 1.9–3.0% vs HBR 0.5–1.1%). (2) **Unique rates are identical between the 10k-read mini and the 100k+ read full round** (HBR 53.0–53.3 vs 51.7–51.8; UHR 45.1–49.9 vs 44.6–48.5) — the profile is a property of the reads, not of depth. (3) The homework round’ s ~47–53% “unmapped: too short” (vs 11–13% in mini, same reads, different index) is a property of the **full-genome index + BySJout combination** on this pre-filtered library content: reads whose best full-genome alignment falls below the filter thresholds are dropped as “too short” . The mini chr22 index reproduces the course’ s own numbers; the full index trades coverage for stringency. Record, don’ t panic: the uniquely-mapped fraction that feeds quantification is consistent.

Pitfalls. RNA-05 (shebang `#!/bin/bash` in the printed batch script — cosmetic). RNA-13 (thread count 1 vs 4 — classroom load design; our homework round used 4 with a memory guard: before every STAR invocation, wait until `MemAvailable` ≥ 37 GB, because loading the full index costs ~31 GB and the login node is shared). The mini index needs only ~0.4 GB — that round needed no guard.

Tuning. `--runThreadN` up on a quiet node; `--twopassMode Basic` improves novel-junction sensitivity at ~2× cost; `--outSAMtype BAM SortedByCoordinate` saves a samtools sort if genome-coordinate tools come next.

Extensions. samtools sort/index + flagstat for BAM QC; RSeQC (infer_experiment, inner_distance) for strandedness and insert profiles; `--quantMode GeneCounts` for a quick raw count matrix alongside the transcriptome BAM.

6. 汇总质控 (multiqc)

Original (homework cell; mini uses the real working directory):

```
multiqc /lustre1/share/RNA_seq_student/yourfold
```

Rationale. multiqc walks a directory tree, recognizes tool outputs it knows (fastqc zips, fastp JSON/HTML, STAR Log.final.out, salmon quant.sf, ...), and merges them into one report with per-sample columns — the fastest way to see all twelve fastq files and six samples side by side.

What we ran. multiqc "\$PWD" -o multiqc_report (RNA-06: the printed path is a placeholder — yourfold is literally “your folder”). Both rounds produced the aggregated report; the STAR and fastp numbers quoted in this document are cross-checkable there.

Pitfalls. RNA-06 (placeholder path). Also note: multiqc only reports what it finds under the given path — pointing it at the wrong directory “succeeds” with an empty report rather than failing.

Tuning. `-f` to rebuild, `--cl` to embed the command line in the report, a multiqc_config.yaml to pin module order for teaching. **Extensions.** `--pdf` export; running multiqc at the end and at the mid-pipeline point (post-STAR) gives before/after views.

7. 定量 I: 比对模式 (salmon align mode)

Original (homework batch cell — the correct one; see RNA-03 for the single-sample cell’ s mangled filename):

```
TRANSCRIPTOME="/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome/GRCh38_no_alt_analysis_set_gencode.v36.transcripts.fa"
for bam_file in $(ls Aligned.toTranscriptome.out.bam); do
    sample_name=$(basename "$bam_file" Aligned.toTranscriptome.out.bam)
    salmon quant -t "$TRANSCRIPTOME" --libType A -a "$bam_file" -o "${sample_name}
_align.salmon_quant" --gcBias --seqBias
    echo "Processed: $sample_name"
done
```

Rationale. This is alignment-based quantification: STAR already decided where each read goes; salmon’ s align mode (`-a`) takes the transcriptome-coordinate BAM, assigns multi-mapping reads fractionally by EM, and estimates abundance per transcript. `--gcBias --seqBias` correct observed sequence-content and GC biases from the alignments themselves. `-t` is the transcriptome fasta the BAM’ s transcript names refer to; `--libType A` lets salmon infer the library type.

What we ran. All six samples in both rounds; **100.0% of fragments “mapped” in every sample** — which is exactly what it sounds like and not a quality number: the input BAM contains only fragments STAR already aligned, so the denominator is “aligned fragments” , not “reads in the library” (RNA-12).

Pitfalls. RNA-03 (the single-sample demo cell’ s filename is a UHR/HBR paste-mix — copy it and it fails at file-not-found). RNA-02 (the mini single-sample cell omits `--gcBias --seqBias` while its batch cell includes them — quantifying one sample by the demo command and the rest by the batch script produces systematically different corrections across samples).

Interpretation. Align mode inherits every STAR decision (junction filters, multimap caps, the too-short drops). Its counts are “STAR’ s view of the transcriptome” ; quasi mode (section 8) is salmon’ s own, more conservative view — that contrast is the point of running both.

Tuning. -p threads; --posBias if positional attenuation is suspected. **Extensions.** RSEM is the classical alternative for the same BAM; --numBootstraps adds uncertainty replicates tximport can consume.

8. 定量 II：选择性比对模式 (salmon quasi / --validateMappings)

Original (homework batch cell):

```
INDEX="/lustre1/share/RNA_seq/genome/salmon_index"
for r1 in $(ls *.read1.fastq.gz); do
  base=$(basename "$r1" .read1.fastq.gz)
  r2=$(echo $base | sed s/read1/read2/)
  salmon quant -i $INDEX \
    -l A \
    -1 "$r1" \
    -2 "$r2" \
    --validateMappings \
    --gcBias --seqBias \
    -p 8 \
    -o "${base}_quasi.salmon_quant"
  echo "Processed: $base"
done
```

Rationale. Quasi mode maps raw reads directly against a transcriptome index (no genome, no junctions to discover). --validateMappings (salmon ≥1.0's default mapping engine) validates candidate mappings by selective alignment — an alignment-score threshold decides membership instead of a plain k-mer hash hit, which is why its mapping rate reads lower than STAR's: reads without a good transcriptome alignment are discarded rather than force-placed.

What we ran (mapping rates, num_mapped / num_processed from aux_info/meta_info.json):

Round	Mode	HBR_Rep1	HBR_Rep2	HBR_Rep3	UHR_Rep1	UHR_Rep2	UHR_Rep3
mini	direct (trimmed reads)	36.5%	36.5%	36.4%	33.8%	31.2%	32.2%
homework	quasi (raw reads, as written)	35.2%	35.3%	35.1%	32.6%	30.3%	32.0%

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Pitfalls. RNA-04 is the important one: for r1 in \$(ls *.read1.fastq.gz) matches only the **raw** files (*.read1.fastq.gz ends differently), so the homework quasi mode quantifies **untrimmed** reads while the mini direct mode quantifies trimmed — we ran it as written and recorded it (adapter fragments are short enough that mapping rates barely move, but the preprocessing story differs between the two documents). Also RNA-12: 30–37% here versus 100% in align mode is a **denominator difference**, not a quality collapse.

Interpretation. Two independent effects set the ~1/3 rate: the reads are pre-filtered to chr22+ERCC content while the index is the full 231,448-transcript GENCODE v36 (salmon discards what doesn't align well anywhere), and selective alignment is score-thresholded. The rates are remarkably stable across rounds (35.1–36.5% HBR, 30.3–33.8% UHR) — again a property of the libraries, reproducible at two depths.

Tuning. -p 8 is printed in the homework batch cell — on a shared login node that is already a real thread budget. **Extensions.** --numBootstraps 100 + tximport's countsFromAbundance path gives bootstrap-aware variance; --seqBias interacts with fragment-length distributions — check f1dLen.png in the output when QC-ing.

9. 读入定量结果并过滤 (tximport → edgeR)

Original (R cells, step-by-step path):

```
salmon_files <- list.files(pattern = "quant\\.sf$", full.names = TRUE, recursive = TRUE)
salmon_files <- salmon_files[grepl("quasi", salmon_files)] # homework; mini greps "_direct"
txi <- tximport(salmon_files, type = "salmon", txOut = TRUE)
dge <- DGEList(counts = txi$counts)
counts_threshold <- 10
samples_threshold <- 2
keep <- rowSums(dge$counts >= counts_threshold) >= samples_threshold
dge_filtered <- dge[keep, ]
sample_info <- data.frame(
  sample = colnames(dge_filtered),
  condition = factor(c(rep("HBR", 3), rep("UHR", 3))) # change based on samples
)
design <- model.matrix(~condition, data = sample_info)
```

Rationale. tximport gathers per-sample quant.sf (Name, Length, TPM, NumReads) into one matrix; txOut = TRUE keeps the rows at **transcript level** (231,448 rows against the full index). The filter (≥ 10 counts in ≥ 2 samples) kills rows too sparse to model — at this library size that is almost everything, by construction of the dataset (chr22+ERCC-origin reads against a whole-transcriptome index).

What we ran (and what to check before the design matrix — RNA-01):

Check	mini	homework
transcripts in index	4,989 (chr22 mini)	231,448 (full GENCODE v36)
transcripts kept	111	831
colnames(txi\$counts)	NULL → Sample1–6	NULL → Sample1–6
order that saved the day	HBR×3 then UHR×3 (alphabetical)	HBR×3 then UHR×3 (alphabetical)

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Pitfalls. RNA-01 is the structural one, in three links: (1) list.files() returns alphabetical order and the printed condition vector hard-codes HBR-first — correct **only by luck of the filenames**; (2) because the files are passed unnamed, colnames is NULL and edgeR invents Sample1–6 — sample identity is purely positional from here on; (3) nothing downstream (design matrix, contrasts, sample_info rownames in the heatmap) can catch a permutation. The fix that costs one line: names(salmon_files) <- sub("...sample pattern...", ..., salmon_files) and build condition from those names. Both rounds' checks printed above — order held both times, recorded, not assumed. RNA-14: export LC_ALL=C; export LANG=C before R (the tutorial carries this itself).

Interpretation. 111/4,989 and 831/231,448 look like different survival rates but are the same phenomenon at two index breadths: ~2% of rows pass in both. Depth sets how many transcripts clear 10 counts (111 → 831), the index sets the denominator.

Tuning. Raising counts_threshold with depth (10 is for this teaching scale; whole-transcriptome studies commonly require ≥ 10 –20 CPM-like floors). **Extensions.** txOut = FALSE + a tx2gene frame aggregates to gene level before edgeR (the more common production path); DESeq2 with tximport is the drop-in alternative; rtracklayer/biomaRt (already loaded by the tutorial) can rebuild the annotation.

10. 差异表达、注释与火山图 (glmLRT + volcano)

Original (R cells):

```
dge_filtered <- estimateDisp(dge_filtered, design)
fit <- glmFit(dge_filtered, design)
results <- glmLRT(fit)
results_table <- topTags(results, n = Inf)$table
```

```

results_table$regulate <- ifelse(results_table$FDR < 0.05 & results_table$logFC > 1, "up-
regulated",
                                ifelse(results_table$FDR < 0.05 & results_table$logFC < -1,
"down-regulated", "not sig"))
gene_anno <- readRDS("/lustre1/share/RNA_seq_class/genome/gene_anno_gencode.v36.rds")
rownames_nover <- sub("\\.*$", "", rownames(results_table))
anno_transcript_nover <- sub("\\.*$", "", gene_anno$transcript_id)
match_index <- match(rownames_nover, anno_transcript_nover)
results_table$gene_name <- gene_anno$gene_name[match_index]
results_table$label <- ifelse(results_table$regulate != "not sig", results_table$gene_name,
NA_character_)

```

Rationale. edgeR' s generalized-linear-model path: estimateDisp estimates the negative-binomial dispersion, glmFit fits, glmLRT likelihood-ratio-tests the last term (here conditionUHR). The regulate rule is a conjunction: $FDR < 0.05$ **and** $|\log FC| > 1$ — statistical significance and effect size together, which is why the volcano' s dashed lines sit at ± 1 and $-\log_{10}(0.05)$. The annotation block strips GENCODE version suffixes (ENST00000615943.1 $\rightarrow$ ENST00000615943) **on both sides** before match() — note this is exactly the discipline the heatmap block forgets (section 12).

What we ran:

	mini	homework (full)
up-regulated	15	171
down-regulated	30	148
not significant	66	512
Matched (gene_name)	111 / 111	831 / 831
top up (by FDR)	IGLC2 ($\log FC \approx +10.3$, $FDR \approx 1e-145$), IGLC3, XBP1, MYH9	IGLC2, IGLC3, ...
top down	MIAT (≈ -8.5), YWHAH, MAPK8IP2, SYNGR1, ACO2, SYNGR1, SEPTIN3, CBX7	SEPTIN3, YWHAH, RPL3, CBX6, ...

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Interpretation — the SEQC truth check. Every direction matches the known answer: **UHR up:** immunoglobulin lambda chains IGLC2/IGLC3 (UHR' s pool includes immune-cell RNA) — textbook; **HBR up (i.e., UHR-down):** MIAT, YWHAH, MAPK8IP2, ACO2, SYNGR1, SEPTIN3 — brain-enriched transcripts. The top gene is the same transcript at both depths (IGLC2, $|\log FC| > 10$ at $FDR \sim 1e-145$) — the signal was already saturated at 10k reads; depth bought more called genes (45 $\rightarrow$ 319), not a different answer. That is the core lesson of the mini/homework pairing.

Pitfalls. RNA-15 (ggrepel: 9 / 280 unlabeled data points — decluttering, benign). glmLRT takes the fitted object; passing extra arguments changes the tested term (caught and corrected during our mini-round harvest — the tutorial' s own call glmLRT(fit) is the right one).

Tuning. topTags(n = Inf) then sorting by logFC shows strong-effect genes the FDR sort hides. **Extensions.** decideTests + Venn across contrasts; topTags with adjust.method = "BH" is the default FDR here.

11. 富集分析 (GO — and the KEGG that never runs)

Original (step-by-step cells — the executable path):

```

gene_list <- results_table$gene_name[results_table$regulate == "up-regulated"]
gene_list <- gene_list[!(is.na(gene_list) | gene_list == "")]
#KEGG analysis
#entrez_ids <- mapIds(...)
#kegg_enrich <- enrichKEGG(...)
#go analysis

```

```
go_enrich <- enrichGO(gene = gene_list, OrgDb = org.Hs.eg.db, keyType = "SYMBOL",
                      ont = "ALL", pvalueCutoff = 1, qvalueCutoff = 1)
go_dotplot <- dotplot(go_enrich, showCategory = 10, title = "GO Enrichment")
ggsave("GO_dotplot_up_regulate.pdf", plot = go_dotplot, width = 7, height = 5)
```

Rationale. Enrichment asks whether the up-regulated gene set is annotation-fold-enriched versus the background. `keyType = "SYMBOL"` feeds gene symbols directly (no manual ID conversion); `ont = "ALL"` pools BP+MF+CC; `pvalueCutoff = 1` disables the display-side cutoff so the top-10 sort is by actual significance.

What we ran. 15 up genes (mini) / 171 (homework). Homework top GO categories (`p.adjust 0.0075–0.0088`): viral RNA genome replication, single-stranded viral RNA replication via double-stranded DNA intermediate, glycosyl compound catabolic process, protein targeting to mitochondrion, DNA dealkylation, cytidine catabolic process, cytidine deamination, cytidine-to-uridine editing. The same top categories appear in the teacher’s reference `GO_dotplot.pdf` (viral RNA genome replication, glycosyl compound catabolic process, `p.adjust 0.0075`) — cross-validated against the reference, not just self-consistent.

Pitfalls — RNA-07/08, both about the consolidated “CODES” cell. The step-by-step cells comment KEGG out with `#` (correct). The consolidated cell instead wraps the whole KEGG block in `''' ... '''`. In R, `'''` is **not** a comment: it parses as an empty string `''` followed by a string-opener `'`, so the entire block becomes **one giant string literal** that R evaluates and auto-prints — it accidentally behaves like a block comment, doing nothing. The failure mode is latent: any apostrophe inside the block would close the string early and the remaining code becomes **live**. Treat `'''` blocks as non-executable prose, always. And RNA-08: the homework’s consolidated cell still filters `"_direct"` (the mini naming) — with homework outputs named `_quasi` it finds zero files and dies at `tximport`; the step-by-step path (`grep1("quasi")`) is the executable one.

Interpretation. The cytidine-deamination/cytidine-to-uridine-editing cluster is not noise: immunoglobulin-expressing cells run AID/APOBEC-driven cytidine deamination for affinity maturation — the GO readout of the same IG signal the volcano shows. The “viral RNA genome replication” style categories are an annotation-side effect of the IG/ERV-region genes in the up set (read with the teacher’s reference, which shows the same).

Tuning. `enrichKEGG` needs ENTREZ IDs (the commented block does the conversion) and network access to KEGG REST — the reason it’s the step usually left off in class. **Extensions.** `compareCluster` across up/down/both sets; GSEA (`gseG0`) on the whole ranked table uses more than the top set.

12. 热图——沉默的全 NA 坑 (the silent all-NA bug)

Original (homework heatmap block, verbatim):

```
logCPM_scaled <- cpm(dge_filtered, log = TRUE, prior.count = 1)
rownames(logCPM_scaled) <- sub("\\..*$", "", rownames(logCPM_scaled))
degs <- results_table[results_table$FDR < 0.05 & abs(results_table$logFC) > 1, ]
top50 <- head(rownames(degs[order(degs$FDR), ]), 50)
top50_clean <- sub("\\..*$", "", top50)
logCPM_scaled_sub <- logCPM_scaled[top50_clean, ]
gene_map <- setNames(gene_anno$gene_name, gene_anno$transcript_id)
rownames(logCPM_scaled_sub) <- gene_map[rownames(logCPM_scaled_sub)]
rownames(sample_info) <- colnames(logCPM_scaled)
pdf("heatmap_DEG.pdf", width = 10, height = 8)
pheatmap(logCPM_scaled_sub, cluster_rows = TRUE, cluster_cols = TRUE,
          show_rownames = TRUE, annotation_col = sample_info,
          main = "Heatmap of Differentially Expressed Genes")
dev.off()
```

The bug chain, link by link. Line 2 strips versions from the rownames (`ENST00000390323.5` → `ENST00000390323`); line 6 builds `gene_map` with **versioned** keys (`setNames(gene_anno$gene_name, gene_anno$transcript_id)` — no stripping); line 7 looks the stripped names up in the versioned map → **every**

lookup misses; assigning an all-NA vector to rownames is legal in R; pheatmap renders it — **fifty rows labeled “NA” , no error, no warning.** pdf to text heatmap_DEG.pdf from our real run shows exactly 50 × NA. This is the same version-mismatch class as the annotation block in section 10, which gets it right by stripping both sides before `match()` — and the mini version’s heatmap block gets it right too (a `clean_id()` helper applied to both the data rows and the annotation IDs, plus `make.unique()` and `labels_row =`).

The one-line correction (executed and verified):

```
gene_map <- setNames(gene_anno$gene_name, sub("\\..*$", "", gene_anno$transcript_id))
```

Our corrected run (heatmap_DEG_corrected.pdf): **0 of 50 NA**, row labels IGLC2, IGLC3, MCM5, SERPIND1, LIF, ... — the real top-DEG genes.

Pitfalls. RNA-09 (above). RNA-10: the teacher’s reference heatmap_DEG.pdf has **versioned ENST IDs as row labels** — neither gene names (mini-style) nor all-NA (printed-homework-style): the reference run used yet another code variant, so it is not a valid oracle for this block (Appendix B). The homework block also drops the mini version’s `scale = "row"` — rows are raw logCPM, so a highly expressed gene visually swamps the pattern `scale = "row"` would show.

Interpretation. The heatmap’s job here is the visual assertion of the DEG story: samples cluster by condition (HBR vs UHR columns separate), top genes split into the two direction blocks. Labels are the only thing the bug broke — the numbers, clustering, and annotation bar were always right, which is precisely why it survived into the printed handout.

Tuning. `scale = "row"` (z-scores per row), `cutree_rows` to force block structure, `gaps_col = 3` between the two conditions. **Extensions.** `ComplexHeatmap` for annotation-heavy figures; `label_maxsize/fontsize` when 50 labels crowd.

13. 双轮对比 (mini vs homework/full, side by side)

	mini (2026-09-21)	homework/full (2026-10-09)
Reads per sample	10,000	118,571–227,392 pairs
STAR index	chr22 mini, 381 MB	full GRCh38, ~31 GB RAM
STAR unique (HBR / UHR)	53.0–53.3% / 45.1–49.9%	51.7–51.8% / 44.6–48.5%
STAR too short	11.5–12.9%	47.1–52.7% (full index + BySJout stringency)
salmon align mode	100% (aligned-fragment denominator)	100% (same)
salmon direct/quasi	31.2–36.5% (trimmed)	30.3–35.3% (raw, as written)
transcripts in index	4,989	231,448
transcripts kept (≥ 10 counts, ≥ 2 samples)	111 (2.2%)	831 (0.36%)
DEG (FDR<0.05 and $ \log FC > 1$)	45 (15 up / 30 down)	319 (171 up / 148 down)
top gene both directions	IGLC2 (+10.3) / MIAT (–8.5)	IGLC2 / SYNGR1-cluster
Matched annotation	111/111	831/831
GO top terms	(small set)	viral RNA genome replication etc., match teacher reference
heatmap labels	gene names (correct block)	all “NA” as printed → corrected 0/50 NA
wall time	~4 min	13 min
where	login node, serial	login node, serial (memory-guarded STAR)

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What scales and what doesn't. Wall time grew 4 → 13 min (index load dominates; the full index is ~80× the mini one). DEG count grew 45 → 319 (depth buys calls). The answers didn't move: mapping-rate profiles, top genes, and directions are depth-invariant — which is the whole point of running the mini first. The one thing that flipped between rounds was an artifact of the documents, not the data: the mini heatmap block annotates correctly, the homework block doesn't.

14. 检查清单、产物清单与总结 (Checklist, outputs, summary)

检查清单 (checklist — with both rounds' measured answers):

#	Check	mini	full
ck1	sample order before design matrix (HBR×3 first?)	held	held
ck2	colnames(txi\$counts) NULL → Sample1-6 (positional identity)	yes	yes
ck3	STAR unique rate in 44-54% band, HBR above UHR	45.1-53.3%	44.6-51.8%
ck4	multi-loci low, UHR > HBR (IG content)	0.5-2.1%	1.1-3.0%
ck5	quasi mapping 30-37%, align 100% (different denominators — don't compare)	31.2-36.5%	30.3-35.3%
ck6	kept transcripts ~2% and ~0.4% of index at the two breadths	111/4,989	831/231,448
ck7	DEG direction matches SEQC truth (IGL up in UHR, brain genes down)	yes	yes
ck8	top gene identical across depths	IGLC2	IGLC2
ck9	Matched: n/n printed by the annotation block	111/111	831/831
ck10	GO top terms vs teacher reference	—	match (viral RNA genome replication, p.adjust ~0.008)
ck11	heatmap labels are gene names, not "NA"	yes (correct block)	0/50 NA after correction (50/50 NA as printed)
ck12	LC_ALL=C/LANG=C exported before R	yes	yes
ck13	ggrepel "unlabeled" warnings noted benign	9	280

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产物清单 (outputs): both rounds' artifacts live in the repository under RNA-seq/results/ (analysis products only — no raw reads, no BAMs): fastqc/fastp reports, STAR Log.final.out ×6 each, multiqc reports, salmon quant.sf for all 24 quantifications, the R analysis log, the four homework-round PDFs (volcano / GO / **heatmap as printed, all-NA** / **heatmap corrected, 0-NA**) plus the three mini-round PDFs, and both rounds' full summary + deviations logs and runner scripts. The heavy intermediates (BAMs, trimmed/ raw

FASTQs, full salmon directories) stay in the cluster run directories (/lustre1/user/bjx131_pkuhpc/rna_run_mini_20260921/, /lustre1/user/bjx131_pkuhpc/rna_run_homework_20261009/).

总结. The pipeline is sound; the pitfalls are in the hand-written seams around it — sample identity carried only by position and alphabetical luck, two salmon modes whose mapping rates share no denominator, a quasi-mode loop that quietly quantifies raw reads, and a heatmap annotation rewrite that silently renders 50 unlabeled rows. Every one of them was reproduced on real runs, and every fix was executed and verified. The SEQC dataset did its job throughout: the biological answer (IGLC2 up, brain genes down) was stable at both depths and matched the teacher’s reference wherever the reference was comparable — which, as Appendix B shows, is itself something to verify, not assume.

附录 A. 偏差日志 (both rounds, condensed but verbatim-faithful)

Full logs: RNA-seq/results/mini/log/ and RNA-seq/results/homework/log/ (summary + deviations + R analysis).

mini round (2026-09-21) — selection:

DEVIATION: workdir = own run dir (tutorial: classroom share dir); no writes to the classroom share
DEVIATION: tutorial-native interactive mode: serial single-process run on the login node – campus-wide SLURM submission outage (all sbatch rejected; sacct empty since 9/15; the WES scripts that ran successfully on 9/20 also rejected → cluster-side, not ours)
DEVIATION: SLURM env-var guard + deviation logging added to the teacher's load-test script shape
DEVIATION: single consolidated runner script (tutorial assumes interactive typing)
FINDING: sample order fragility holds (list.files alphabetical, HBR×3 first, condition correct)
FINDING: tximport unnamed files → colnames NULL → edgeR Sample1-6 (positional dependence)
FINDING: KEGG block is a doc bug (step-by-step cells comment it with #; consolidated wraps in ''')
FINDING: ggrepel 9 unlabeled benign

homework round (2026-10-09) — selection:

DEVIATION: workdir = own run dir (tutorial: /lustre1/share/RNA_seq_student_2026_homework/{id})
DEVIATION: tutorial-native interactive mode on the login node, per user directive 2026-10-09 – SLURM had RECOVERED by probe time (test-only alloc OK on cn-long) but the tutorial's own design is direct interactive execution; recorded, not used this round
DEVIATION: restart guards (skip steps whose outputs exist); STAR memory guard (wait for MemAvailable ≥ 37 GB before each invocation – index ~31 GB on a shared login node)
DEVIATION: STAR --runThreadN 4 per the homework batch script (single-sample demo cell says 1)
DEVIATION: multiqc: doc cell has placeholder path; used \$PWD like the mini version
DEVIATION: salmon quasi mode runs on RAW reads (glob *read1.fastq.gz matches only untrimmed) – inconsistent with mini's direct mode on trimmed; run AS WRITTEN, recorded
DEVIATION: R step-by-step path used (grep1("quasi")); consolidated CODES cell still filters "_direct" (mini naming) AND wraps KEGG in '' (invalid R) – unusable for homework outputs
FINDING: heatmap row labels ALL "NA" (gene_map keyed by versioned transcript_id, looked up with version-stripped rownames) – silent; correction pass heatmap_DEG_corrected.pdf: 0/50 NA
FINDING: quasi mapping rate 30–35% on raw reads (mini direct ~32%, consistent)
FINDING: teacher reference heatmap rows are versioned ENST IDs – teacher's actual run used a third code variant; third teacher-vs-doc deviation (cf. class.R salmon_files[-2], the mangled single-sample salmon filename)
RESULT: GO dotplot top categories match teacher reference (viral RNA genome replication, glycosyl compound catabolic process; p.adjust 0.0075 vs 0.0082–0.0088) – cross-validated

附录 B. 教师参考产物 vs 印刷版文档 (evidence, all paths verbatim)

The teacher’s own run left artifacts in /lustre1/share/RNA_seq/. Three independent deviations from the printed documents:

1. **The reference heatmap is a third variant.** /lustre1/share/RNA_seq/heatmap_DEG.pdf row labels are versioned ENST IDs (e.g. ENST00000407418.8). The printed homework block produces all-“NA” labels (RNA-09, reproduced); the mini block produces gene names. The reference matches neither — its code kept the versioned ENST rownames and never renamed them.

2. **class.R drops a sample.** `salmon_files <- salmon_files[-2]` — the 2nd quantification directory is removed before tximport. Consistent with cleanup of a duplicated directory in the teacher's own run area (the share contains both UHR_Rep3...chr22Aligned...bam and a doubled-name UHR_Rep3...chr22_ERCC-Mix2...chr22Aligned...bam), not with any method in the printed documents.
3. **The mangled single-sample salmon cell was actually run.** The doubled-name BAMs above are exactly what the homework's single-sample align cell (RNA-03, UHR name + pasted HBR_ERCC-Mix2...chr22 suffix) produces — the reference area carries the bug's own output filename.

Where the reference is comparable, it agrees with our runs: G0_dotplot.pdf top categories and p.adjust match ours (Appendix A, RESULT). The WES edition's lesson repeats verbatim: reference artifacts are evidence of someone's actual commands, not a proof of the printed ones — diff against them only where the code path is known.

附录 C. 复现 (reproduction)

Both rounds' runner scripts and the R scripts are stored verbatim in RNA-seq/results/mini/scripts/ and RNA-seq/results/homework/scripts/, next to their full logs. The homework runner documents its own wrapping deviations in its header comment (SLURM header kept for provenance only — the round ran tutorial-native on the login node). Re-running the mini round takes ~4 minutes and needs only the shared environment; re-running the homework round takes ~13 minutes serial and needs ~31 GB free for each STAR invocation.